CHERYL MANALO

Product Marketing Leadership Portfolio
Developer Platforms • AI • DevOps



Anaconda

Transforming a Data Science, Python Package Manager to an AI-Native Development Platform

Every company wants to be an AI platform. Most are missing the point.

By Cheryl Manalo

May 28, 2026

Just last year, Anaconda announced it was becoming an AI platform. At the time, the industry was still actively defining what that even meant.

The market was moving fast. Infrastructure companies became AI infrastructure companies overnight. Developer tools became AI developer tools. Data platforms became AI platforms. Everyone was racing to participate in the AI wave.

But as the industry evolved, something deeper started becoming clear: AI development itself was fundamentally changing. Since then, a lot has changed at Anaconda too.

We launched a curated model catalog designed for secure enterprise AI experimentation. The goal was to give organizations a trusted, governed foundation for discovering, evaluating, and deploying open-source AI safely and at scale.

More importantly, our perspective evolved alongside the market. Through our acquisition of Outerbounds and the conversations happening across the industry between our founder Peter Wang, Outerbounds co-founder, Ville Tuulos, and our CEO David DeSanto, we increasingly recognized that the next era of software development would look fundamentally and architecturally different from the last.

Software Development Is Becoming AI-Native

For years, software development followed relatively deterministic patterns. Applications were predictable. Infrastructure was stable. Workflows were structured around APIs, databases, and services behaving in known ways. AI changes that.

Modern AI systems are probabilistic, multi-step, and increasingly autonomous. They involve models, agents, orchestration layers, retrieval systems, observability, governance, evaluation loops, and continuous iteration.

You May Also Like

NVIDIA Nemotron 3 Ultra Is Now Available from Anaconda

Anna Ratner

Your Python Workflow, Now AI-Ready

Owen Price

Anaconda MCP: AI Development on Anaconda's Trusted, Secure Foundation

Daina Bouquin

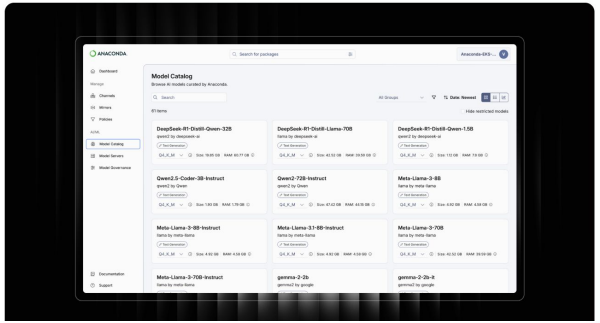
Home / Anaconda Platform / AI Catalyst

AI CATALYST

Model Catalog

Discover and access 50+ curated, benchmarked open source LLMs stored in your private cloud, with complete governance controls, performance metrics, and AI Bill of Materials for every model.

Talk to Sales | Get a Demo



LAUNCH WEEK

New From Anaconda

New tools and capabilities across the full Anaconda platform — from local AI development to enterprise environment governance.

- Secure by Default
- Trusted AI Workflows
- Developer Velocity

Anaconda’s enterprise AI platform narrative

Research and consensus before execution

01 **Customer and analyst insight**

Investigated what was blocking enterprise customers from implementing AI in production.

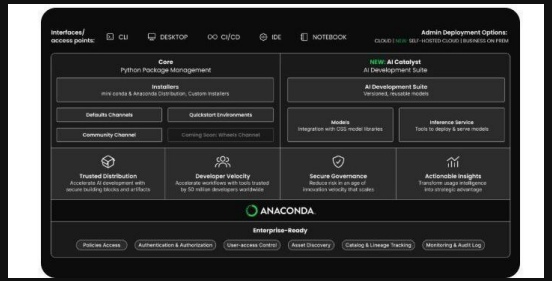
02 **Internal alignment**

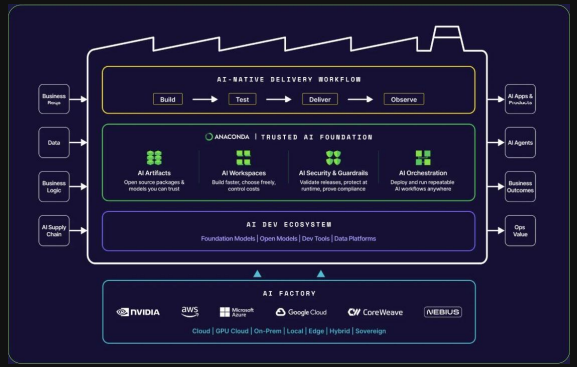
Built consensus on how acquired capabilities should fit the platform, including before close.

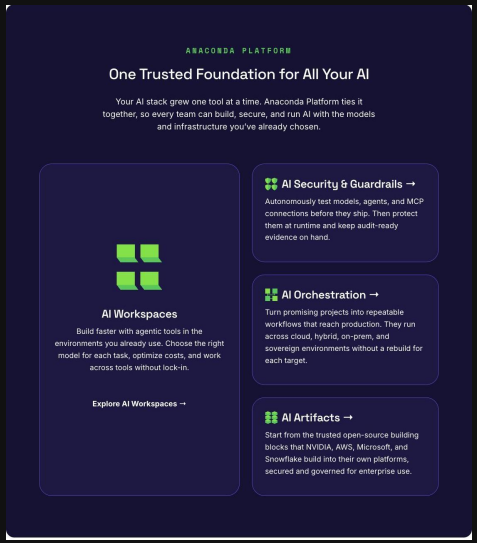
03 **Portfolio narrative**

Helped establish an enterprise platform story that connected the expanding portfolio.

Consolidating solutions into an expanded platform narrative







Phase 1 (Nov 2025)

AI artifacts: Python package environment manager + OSS model catalog

Portfolio slide 2

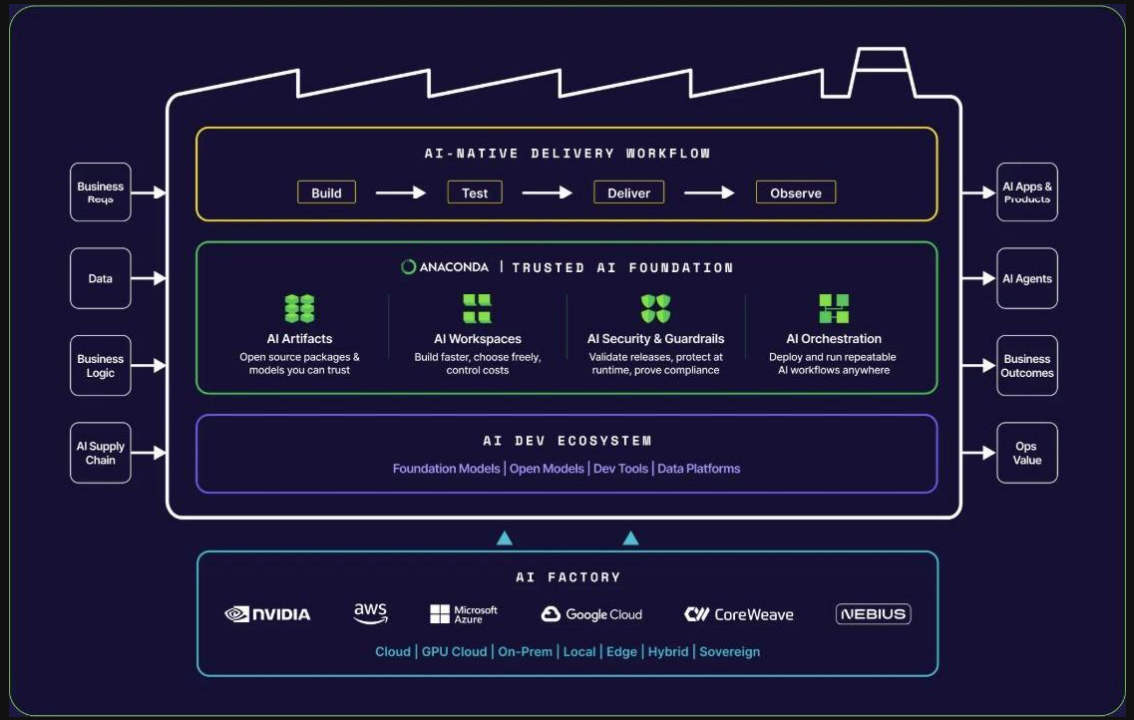
Current: Expanded platform overview

AI Dev Factory workflow

Homepage application

Four capability pillars

High-level visual of a customer workflow



1 Customer workflow

Build, test, deliver, and observe create a clear operating sequence.

2 Four capabilities

The same four pillars sit within the delivery story.

3 Choice and context

The ecosystem and infrastructure show where the platform fits.

CircleCI

Building category leadership in CI/CD via the State of Software Delivery Report



Flagship content program:

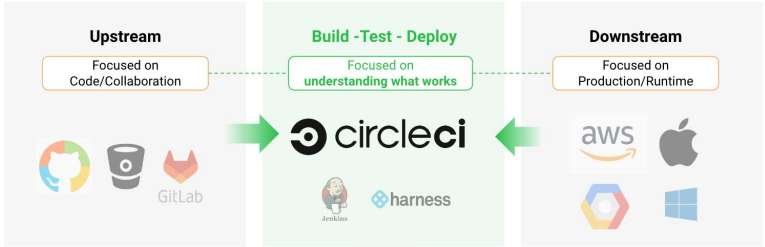
- Led PMM strategy for CircleCI's annual data-backed report aligning product vision with market trends
- Created full GTM package: messaging, sales enablement, blog, and campaign assets
- Drove 3x organic traffic, 100s of MQLs, and supported enterprise sales conversations

https://circleci.com/landing-pages/assets/2020-State-of-Software_Metrics-Report_Final.pdf

CircleCI Challenge

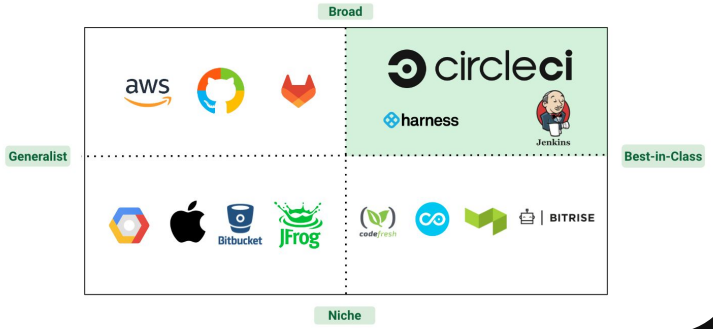
Differentiate a CI/CD platform in an increasingly crowded DevOps market.

The CI/CD market is massive.
We compete primarily with our partners.



We're here - and it's not because of luck.

The CI/CD market is massive.
CircleCI competes as a broad and best-in-class product.



Analyst sentiment tracking

Company
Overall analysts have a somewhat positive view of our business.

- Forrester: "CircleCI is good at staying Innovative"
- Forrester: "Strategic vision below par"
- Gartner: "Attractive option for customers in highly regulated industries"
- IDC: "Weak integration of acquisitions"

Market
CircleCI goes against what the analysts are seeing and saying.

- IDC: "GitHub Migration tool makes it super easy to transition"
- IDC: "Consolidation and preference for DevOps platforms"
- Gartner: "You should implement more AI/ML capabilities"
- Forrester: "Companies where engineers get to choose their tools will be more likely to choose CircleCI"
- Forrester: "Only 20% of clients let their engineers choose their tools.

Product
CircleCI is seen to have a strong offering and decent roadmap.

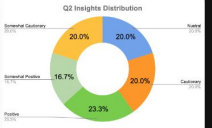
- Gartner: "Lack of built-in security"
- Gartner: "Limited Software software delivery metrics"
- Gartner: "Broad platform support"
- Forrester: "On par roadmap"
- Forrester: "Pragmatic balance between developer concerns, needs of platform teams, and support for enterprise"
- IDC: "Variety of execution environments and resource classes"
- IDC: "Reporting dashboarding & industry standard metrics"

Go-To-Market
Decent GTM but we need to include analysts more for more input.

- Forrester: "One of the best pricing models"
- IDC: "Ongoing reputation damage control"
- IDC: "Surface more SOSDR data to clients"
- Redmonk: "Platform engineering should be more part of your GTM messaging"
- Redmonk: "The sources of change material is a differentiator to GitHub and GitLab"

Customers
We're seen as favored by developers but analysts don't know more beyond that.

- IDC: "Good reputation with customers:
- Gartner: "Easy to implement"
- Forrester: "CircleCI is a great fit for dev teams that value team autonomy and superfast build automation"
- Forrester: "It's unclear how CircleCI gets input from clients"



Average Sentiment
3.033
Cautionary — Positive

Topic	#	% to Goal
Insights	30	N/A
Inquiries	9	150%
Briefings	1	100%
Mentions	7	350%
Custom	2	66

Overview:
Internally, my team owned and maintained the CircleCI Blueprint—our core marketecture document that houses key messaging, positioning statements, and a comprehensive platform overview.

It also captured our current stance in the competitive landscape, analyst perspectives, and trends from our customer base, including ideal customer profile (ICP) data and segmentation insights.

This is a living document that we continuously updated as market conditions shifted, customer data evolved, and our offering grew through roadmap deliverables.

CircleCI Impact

80% Orbs adoption
15% increase in paid conversion
50% increase in ecosystem engagement
Built and scaled PMM organization



Package, ship, and re-use config with orbs.

/ôrb/ noun

A reusable package of YAML configuration that condenses repeated pieces of config into a single line of code.

Explore Orbs | Try CircleCI for Free



Why use an orb?

Orbs are reusable snippets of code that help automate repeated processes, speed up project setup, and make it easy to integrate with third-party tools.

- Save time on project configuration
- Increase organizational efficiency
- Simplify third-party integrations

HOW TO USE AN ORB

Use a pre-built orb

To use a pre-built orb, copy the config code from the orbs registry into your team's config file. Our extensive list of orbs are held in an open source code library. Try something new without committing days of engineering time to setting up a new system, feature, or DevOps practice.

OR

Create an orb for your team

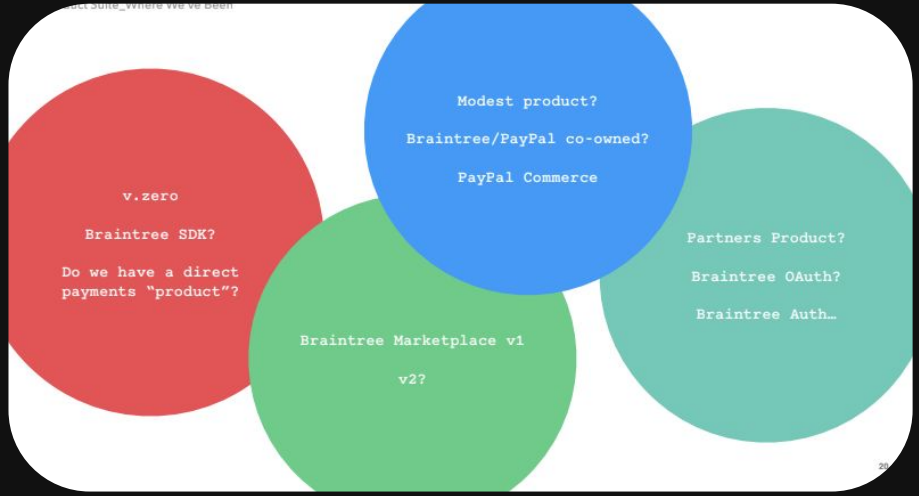
If you don't see an orb that fits your needs, create a specialized orb using our Best Practices and Getting Started guides. Our Orb Development Kit makes the authoring process simple, with automated testing and deployment on CircleCI. If your team wants to share configuration across multiple projects, exclusive to your organization, you can create private orbs. All the orbs you create can be easily tracked, saved for future use, and updated from within the CircleCI application.

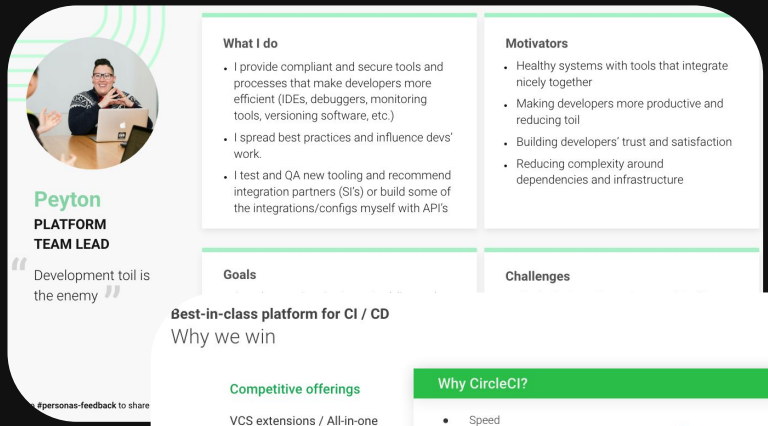
POPULAR ORBS

slack | aws | Microsoft | Google Cloud | salesforce | ATLASSIAN

Messaging & Positioning

Braintree & Paypal offering architecture map: simplification of a multi-product line positioning





Peyton
PLATFORM TEAM LEAD

"Development toil is the enemy"

What I do

- I provide compliant and secure tools and processes that make developers more efficient (IDEs, debuggers, monitoring tools, versioning software, etc.)
- I spread best practices and influence devs' work.
- I test and QA new tooling and recommend integration partners (SI's) or build some of the integrations/configs myself with API's

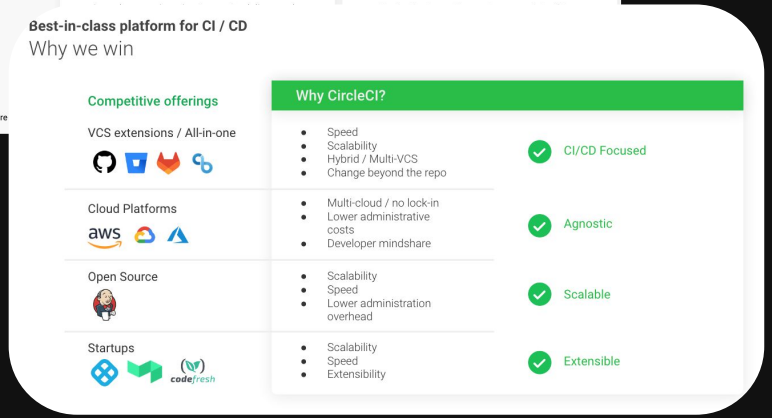
Motivators

- Healthy systems with tools that integrate nicely together
- Making developers more productive and reducing toil
- Building developers' trust and satisfaction
- Reducing complexity around dependencies and infrastructure

Goals

Challenges

#personas-feedback to share



Best-in-class platform for CI / CD

Why we win

Competitive offerings	Why CircleCI?	
VCS extensions / All-in-one	• Speed • Scalability • Hybrid / Multi-VCS • Change beyond the repo	CI/CD Focused
Cloud Platforms	• Multi-cloud / no lock-in • Lower administrative costs • Developer mindshare	Agnostic
Open Source	• Scalability • Speed • Lower administration overhead	Scalable
Startups	• Scalability • Speed • Extensibility	Extensible

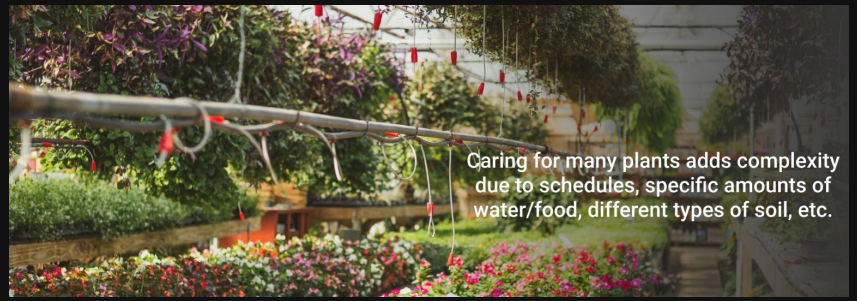
CircleCI Blueprint & enablement content: established a market leader in DevOps & competitive positioning

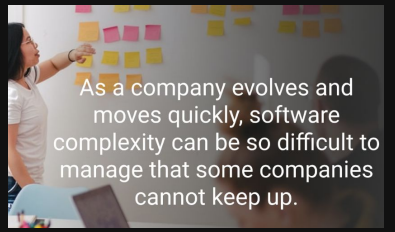
Sample - framework exercise for early-stage startups

Technical Sales Enablement

Lots of tying back key technical concepts to real-life examples, fun analogies, and incorporating them in creative story-telling











CircleCI Writing Samples

https://brand.circleci.com/

https://brand.circleci.com/613faff00/p/253e75-solutions/b/27a22b/t/772e29

https://brand.circleci.com/613faff00/p/9834cb-why-we-win/b/61c00f

https://brand.circleci.com/613faff00/p/77a9bc-product-principles

https://circleci.com/case-studies/bolt/

https://circleci.com/product/

https://circleci.com/developer

https://circleci.com/product-roadmap/

https://www2.circleci.com/forrester-tei-2021.html

Ghost wrote:

https://circleci.com/blog/modernizing-federal-devops-circleci-becomes-first-continuous-integration-tool-with-fedramp-authorization/

https://techcrunch.com/2018/11/07/circleci-launches-orbs-a-package-manager-for-software-delivery-automation/ (Wrote press release that led to getting featured on TechCrunch)

Team contribution & strategic direction:

https://circleci.com/resources/2023-state-of-software-delivery/

https://circleci.com/resources/2022-state-of-software-delivery/

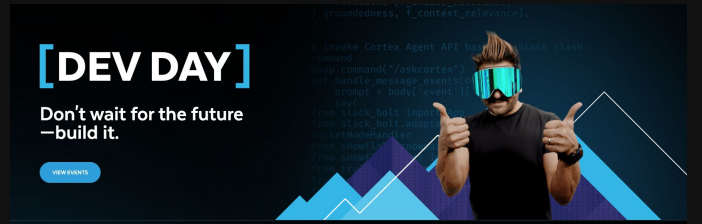
Linear-inspired portfolio redesign

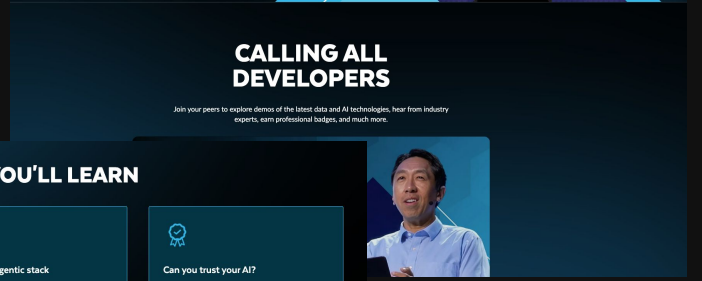
Snowflake

Launched and scaled Snowflake's inaugural developer conference strategy, creating the narrative, positioning, and GTM motion that surpassed registration goals more than a month before the event.

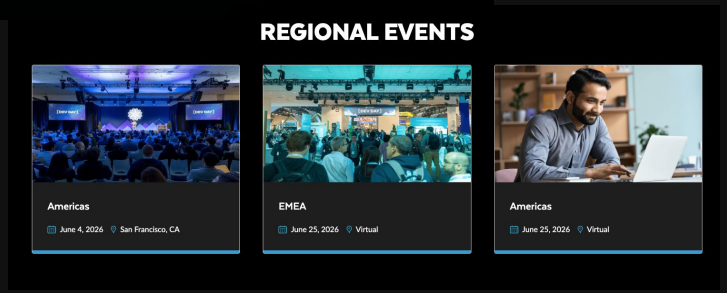
5,000+ registrations secured before launch month





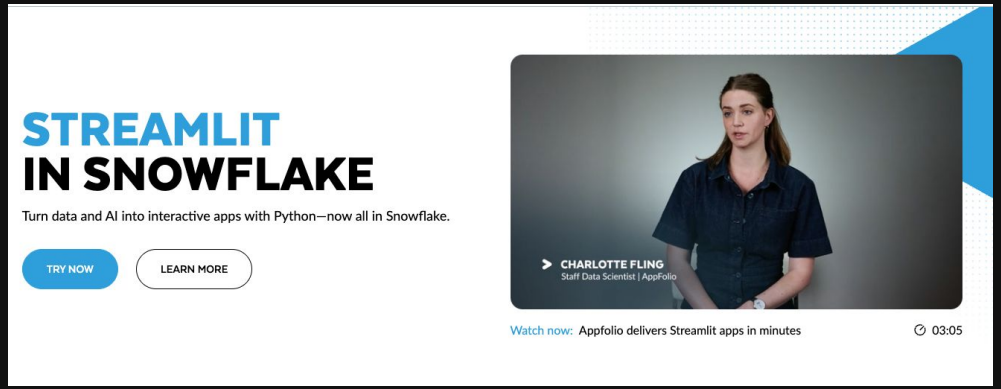


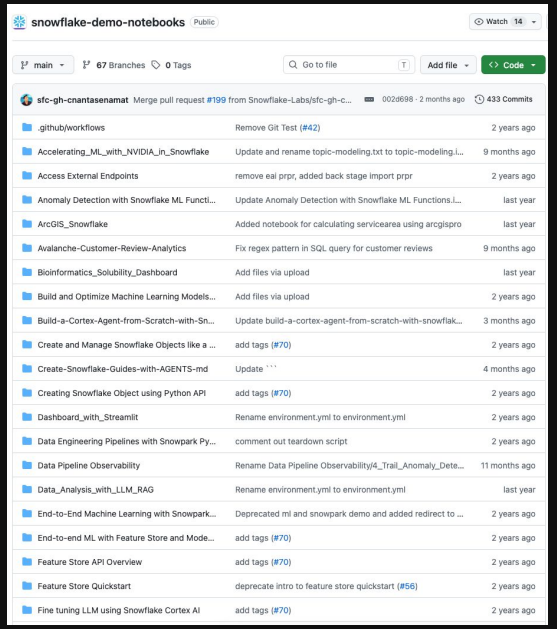


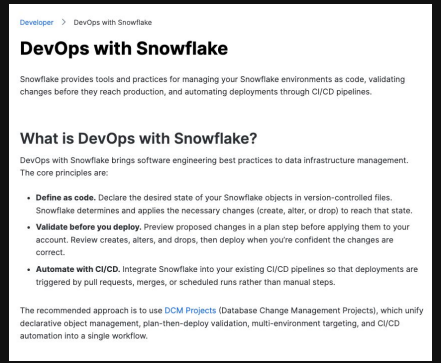


Building the Developer Narrative

Led positioning and GTM launch for Snowflake Notebooks, Streamlit, Copilot, and DevOps experiences.







Snowflake Writing Samples

https://www.snowflake.com/en/data-cloud/overview/streamlit-in-snowflake/

https://www.snowflake.com/blog/python-api-empowers-data-engineers-build-data-pipelines/

Ghost wrote:

https://medium.com/snowflake/streamlit-in-snowflake-generally-available-for-aws-commercial-73ea1da1bdf2

https://www.snowflake.com/blog/copilot-ai-powered-sql-assistant/

https://www.snowflake.com/blog/introducing-snowflake-notebooks/

https://www.snowflake.com/blog/simplified-end-to-end-development/

0-1 PMM Contract

Inngest

Defining Durable Execution for AI Native Development

- Positioning
- ICP framework
- JTBD model
- Launch Week strategy

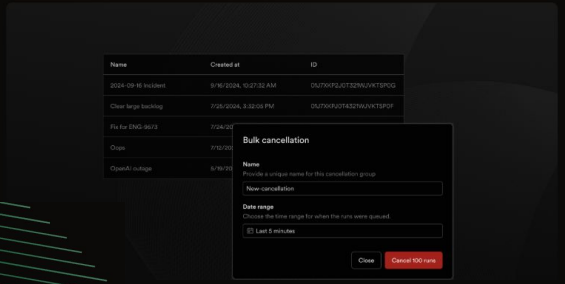
Bulk cancellation UI: the latest addition to Inngest's recovery tool suite

Handle incidents

Cheryl Manalo · 9/27/2024 · 5 min read

The Bulk Cancellation UI feature is the latest addition to Inngest's powerful recovery tool suite, designed to help users manage and recover from incidents with ease. Alongside tools like **Pause** and **Replay**, this feature provides a higher-level declarative approach to managing your workflows.

With Bulk Cancellation, users can cancel running functions in bulk by specifying a specific time range and selecting one or more function states. This ensures you only cancel the exact runs that you need to cancel - not a complete "purge."



Enhanced observability with Inngest: Waterfall trace view and advanced monitoring

A new era for monitoring durable functions

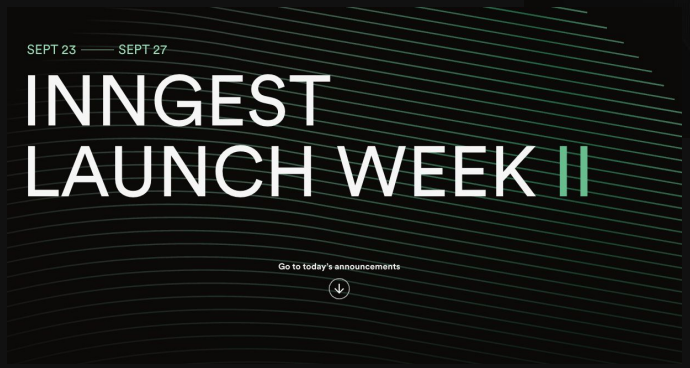
Cheryl Manalo · 9/26/2024 (Updated: 1/6/2026) · 6 min read

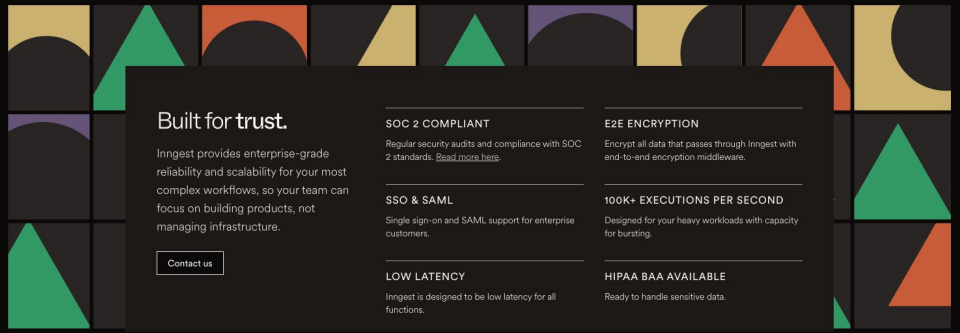
At Inngest, we are constantly evolving to meet the needs of developers building applications with durable execution. Today, we're excited to unveil two significant updates designed to enhance how you monitor, debug, and gain insights into your durable workflows: **our new trace experience for runs and a holistic top-down monitoring dashboard**. Together, these updates redefine how you interact with your function executions and provide deeper insights into the overall health of your Inngest applications.

A fresh perspective on function execution: The new trace experience for runs

Managing workflows can get complex, especially with parallel steps, concurrency limits, and multiple functions running simultaneously. Previously, our function run view displayed function steps in a vertical timeline, which often made it difficult to grasp the sequence and relationships between steps.

To address this, we've introduced a dynamic **waterfall view** and **expanded run details**, inspired by OpenTelemetry tracing. These features make it easier than ever to visualize complex workflows and troubleshoot faster. Here's how they enhance your observability:





Inngest Writing Samples

https://www.inngest.com/blog/simplifying-queues-modern-kafka-alternative
https://www.inngest.com/customers/otto
https://www.inngest.com/blog/bulk-cancellation
https://www.inngest.com/blog/enhanced-observability-traces-and-metrics
https://www.inngest.com/compare-to-temporal
https://www.inngest.com/compare-to-legacy-queues
https://www.inngest.com/ai

Ghost wrote:
https://www.inngest.com/blog/principles-of-durable-execution
https://www.inngest.com/blog/why-your-queue-is-slowing-you-down

The new PMM operating system: AI optimized, designed to scale lean teams

Market Intelligence → Positioning → Launch Strategy → Enablement → Adoption → Expansion



Selected Work

Building products people understand, adopt, and advocate for.
cherylmanalo-15.github.io/cheryl-resume-website

Linear-inspired portfolio redesign